

AUTOMATION + AI

# WEEK 04

# VAULT

Five under-surfaced open-source automation tools — schedulers, glue, and scrapers — each with a ready-to-paste prompt.

JUNE 2026 • 5 PICKS • EN / AR

> [Windmill](#) > [Activepieces](#) > [changedetection.io](#) > [Apprise](#) > [Trigger.dev](#)



# Welcome to the Vault.

This week is all about the automation layer — the self-hosted engines, glue tools, and monitors that quietly do the boring work for you while you sleep. Not the names already plastered on every feed, but the under-surfaced ones that actually move the needle. Each pick comes with what it does, why it matters for you, the real GitHub link, and a prompt you paste straight into your AI to get it running.

## ► HOW TO USE EACH PICK

1. Read the hook — decide in 5 seconds if it's for you.
2. Open the GitHub link.
3. Copy the **>\_ DROP THIS INTO YOUR AI** prompt into Claude, ChatGPT, or Codex.
4. Let it walk you through setup & first use. No guesswork.

هالأسبوع كله عن طبقة الأتمتة — المحركات اللي تستضيفها بنفسك، وأدوات الربط، والمراقبات اللي تسوي الشغل الممل عنك وأنت نايم. مش الأسماء اللي تشوفها بكل مكان، بل الأدوات السرية اللي فعلاً تفرق. كل أداة معها شرح، وليش تهملك أنت، ورابط GitHub الحقيقي، وبرومبت جاهز تنسخه في Claude أو ChatGPT أو Codex وتبدأ على طول.

## THIS WEEK

|    |                    |                              |
|----|--------------------|------------------------------|
| 01 | Windmill           | WORKFLOW ENGINE • SELF-HOST  |
| 02 | Activepieces       | AI AUTOMATION • MCP-NATIVE   |
| 03 | changedetection.io | CHANGE MONITOR • SCRAPER     |
| 04 | Apprise            | NOTIFICATION GLUE • CLI      |
| 05 | Trigger.dev        | BACKGROUND JOBS • CODE-FIRST |

AUTOMATION / INFRA • WINDMILL LABS

# Windmill

01

★ ~17k • 13x faster than Airflow • verdict BOTH

Turn any script into a webhook, a scheduled job, a workflow, or an auto-generated UI — without standing up a single server. Windmill is the self-hosted backbone behind serious internal tooling.

حوّل أي سكربت إلى webhook، أو مهمة مجدولة، أو workflow، أو واجهة تتولد تلقائيًا — بدون ما تركّب ولا سيرفر واحد. Windmill هو العمود الفقري اللي يبنون عليه الأدوات الداخلية الجادة.

## WHAT IT IS

Windmill is an open-source developer platform that takes a plain Python, TypeScript, Go, Bash, or SQL script and instantly wraps it as an API, a background job, a step in a larger flow, or a working app with a UI generated from your function's arguments. You compose steps into workflows with branching, retries, and approvals, then trigger them by schedule, webhook, HTTP route, or email. It self-hosts in one Docker command and benchmarks around 13x faster than Airflow on real workloads.

## WHY IT MATTERS FOR YOU

Most people reach for a SaaS the moment they need a scheduled job or an internal dashboard. Windmill collapses scripts, cron, workflows, and internal UIs into one self-hosted stack you fully own — no per-seat pricing, no data leaving your box. The day you outgrow a lone cron line, this is where you land.

```
repo > github.com/windmill-labs/windmill
```

```
>_ DROP THIS INTO YOUR AI
```

```
Set up Windmill (github.com/windmill-labs/windmill) self-hosted on my machine to run scripts as scheduled jobs and workflows. Give me the exact steps: spin it up with Docker Compose, create my first Python script, expose it as a webhook, and schedule it to run on a cron. Then show me how to chain two scripts into a flow with a retry.
```

AUTOMATION / NO-CODE • ACTIVEPIECES

02

# Activepieces

★ ~23k • 450+ pieces • AI agents built in • verdict BOTH

An open-source Zapier you self-host — but with AI agents and MCP baked into the workflow, not bolted on. Build automations that actually reason about your data, for free.

Zapier مفتوح المصدر تستضيفه بنفسك — بس مع AI agents و MCP مدمجة في ال workflow، مش ملصوقة من برّا. ابن أتمتة تفكّر فعلاً في بياناتك، وببلاش.

## WHAT IT IS

Activepieces is a self-hostable automation platform where you build flows visually by connecting 450+ ready-made pieces — Slack, Gmail, Notion, databases, and hundreds more. What sets it apart is native AI: you can drop an AI agent step into any flow to read, judge, and decide, and it ships with broad MCP support so your agents call external tools cleanly. Every piece is a TypeScript package, so extending it or writing your own integration is a few lines of code.

## WHY IT MATTERS FOR YOU

Generic no-code tools choke the moment a workflow needs real judgment — "is this email actually a complaint?" Activepieces puts an AI agent right inside the pipeline, so the automation thinks instead of just routing. Self-hosted and open-source means your customer data never touches someone else's cloud.

repo > [github.com/activepieces/activepieces](https://github.com/activepieces/activepieces)

### > \_ DROP THIS INTO YOUR AI

Help me self-host Activepieces ([github.com/activepieces/activepieces](https://github.com/activepieces/activepieces)) and build my first AI-powered automation. Walk me through the Docker setup, then create a flow that watches a Gmail inbox, uses an AI agent step to classify each email as urgent / normal / spam, and posts the urgent ones to Slack. Explain how the AI piece is configured.

AUTOMATION / MONITORING • DGTLMOON

03

# changedetection.io

★ ~32k • Visualping alternative • self-hosted • verdict BOTH

Stop refreshing pages to catch a price drop, a restock, or a competitor's quiet update. Point this at any URL and it watches 24/7, then pings you the moment something changes.

بطل تعيد تحميل الصفحات عشان تلحق نزول سعر، أو رجوع منتج، أو تحديث صامت من منافس. وجّهه لأي رابط وهو يراقب 24 ساعة، ويرسل لك لحظة ما يتغير أي شي.

## WHAT IT IS

changedetection.io is a self-hosted watcher that monitors any web page and alerts you the instant the content changes. It handles JavaScript-heavy sites via a headless Chrome, drills into exactly the part you care about with XPath, CSS selectors, or JSON/jq filters, and can even log in and click through steps before checking. Notifications fan out to Discord, Telegram, Slack, email, or any webhook — and AI summaries turn a raw diff into "price dropped from 89 to 67".

## WHY IT MATTERS FOR YOU

Price tracking, restock alerts, competitor monitoring, regulatory and job-board changes — all of it is the same problem, and this one tool covers it without a paid SaaS. It's the cleanest entry point into scraping-as-automation: no spider to write, just a URL and a filter. Pair it with a notification flow and you've built a personal market-intel radar.

repo > [github.com/dgtlmoon/changedetection.io](https://github.com/dgtlmoon/changedetection.io)

### > \_ DROP THIS INTO YOUR AI

Set up [changedetection.io](https://github.com/dgtlmoon/changedetection.io) (github.com/dgtlmoon/changedetection.io) self-hosted with Docker to monitor a page I'll name. Walk me through: running it with the Playwright/Chrome container for JS sites, using the visual selector to watch only the price element, setting a check interval, and wiring a Telegram or webhook notification so I get pinged on any change.

AUTOMATION / GLUE • CARONC

04

# Apprise

★ ~17k • 100+ services • one syntax • verdict BOTH

One line of code to push a notification to Telegram, Discord, Slack, email, SMS, or 90+ other services. Apprise is the missing glue that makes every script and cron job actually tell you what happened.

سطر واحد عشان تبعث إشعار لـ Telegram، أو Discord، أو Slack، أو إيميل، أو SMS، أو ٩٠+ خدمة ثانية. Apprise هو الغراء الناقص اللي يخلّي كل سكربت و cron job يقولك فعلاً وش صار.

## WHAT IT IS

Apprise is a tiny but mighty library and command-line tool that sends notifications to almost any service through one consistent syntax. Instead of learning every platform's API, you hand it a simple URL like `tgram://` or `discord://` and it handles the rest — text, images, and attachments where supported. It's a one-line Python import for developers and a single CLI command for sysadmins, which is why it quietly powers the notification layer inside dozens of bigger self-hosted apps.

## WHY IT MATTERS FOR YOU

Every automation eventually needs to tell you something — a backup finished, a scrape found a hit, a server is on fire. Hand-rolling each integration is wasted hours; Apprise replaces all of them with one call. It's the smallest, highest-leverage pick this week: glue you'll reach for in every script you write from now on.

repo > [github.com/caronc/apprise](https://github.com/caronc/apprise)

>\_ DROP THIS INTO YOUR AI

Show me how to use Apprise ([github.com/caronc/apprise](https://github.com/caronc/apprise)) to add notifications to my scripts and cron jobs. Cover both paths: the one-line CLI command to fire a Telegram and a Discord alert, and the Python snippet to send the same notification with an attached file. Then give me a reusable pattern for notifying me when any background job succeeds or fails.

AUTOMATION / DEV • TRIGGER.DEV

05

# Trigger.dev

★ ~15k • no timeouts • self-hostable • verdict BOTH

Write long-running background jobs as normal async TypeScript — no timeouts, no queue plumbing, no infra to babysit. Trigger.dev is the code-first automation layer for builders who'd rather write a function than drag boxes.

اكتب مهام خلفية طويلة كـ async TypeScript عادي — بدون timeouts، بدون إعدادات queues، بدون بنية تحتية تراقبها. Trigger.dev هو طبقة الأتمتة المبنية على الكود لمن يفضل يكتب دالة بدل ما يسحب صناديق.

## WHAT IT IS

Trigger.dev lets you define background jobs and AI workflows as plain async functions in your own codebase, then runs them as durable, long-running tasks that survive restarts and never hit a serverless timeout. You get automatic retries, durable queues, scheduling, and full observability — logs, runs, and traces — without provisioning any of it yourself. It's fully open-source and self-hostable, so the whole engine can live on your own infrastructure.

## WHY IT MATTERS FOR YOU

No-code tools hit a ceiling fast; the moment your automation needs real branching, error handling, or a job that runs for an hour, you want code. Trigger.dev gives you that without rebuilding the boring 80% — queues, retries, durability — every background system needs. It's where Activepieces (pick 02) ends and a real engineering workflow begins.

```
repo > github.com/triggerdotdev/trigger.dev
```

### >\_ DROP THIS INTO YOUR AI

Get me started with Trigger.dev ([github.com/triggerdotdev/trigger.dev](https://github.com/triggerdotdev/trigger.dev)) for code-first background jobs in TypeScript. Walk me through initializing it in a Node project, writing my first long-running task with automatic retries, scheduling it on a cron, and testing it locally. Then explain what self-hosting the engine on my own infra involves.

# That's the Vault for this week.

Five tools, five prompts. Wire up even one this week and let it run the boring part for you — that's the whole point. Real tools you actually deploy, not another feed to scroll.

**Next week:** more under-surfaced picks — local AI agents, data pipelines, and the self-hosted infra most people never set up.

Found one of these useful? Forward this to one person who'd get it. That's how the Vault grows.

خمس أدوات، خمس برومبتات. ركب ولو وحدة هالأسبوع وخلص تشغل الجزء الممل عنك — هذا كل الهدف. أدوات حقيقية تنشرها فعلاً، مش محتوى تتصفحه بس. عجبك وحدة؟ ابعثها لشخص واحد يستفيد. هكذا تكبر الخزينة.

